POTA FT-8 / FT-4 Companion Logger — End User Guide

A lightweight, modern desktop companion app designed to run alongside WSJT-X during Parks on the Air (POTA) activations.

1. Interface Overview

Top Header: Contains the application title, a live progress counter (e.g., Contacts: 0 / 10), and the **Export POTA ADIF** button.

Middle Controls: Features the **My Park** input field (where you enter your park reference like K-1234) and a **Mode** selection drop-down menu (FT-8 or FT-4).

Contact Table: Real-time table displaying Callsign, Band, Mode, Time UTC, Sent report, Rcvd report, and Park reference for every logged contact.

Footer: Displays the live file path status and the **Locate Log File** button for custom WSJT-X log configurations.

2. Getting Started & Setup

1. Set Your Park Reference: Before operating, type your target park number into the *My Park* box (e.g., K-1234).

2. Select Your Mode: Choose either **FT-8** or **FT-4** from the mode drop-down list to match your current radio operation.

3. Verify WSJT-X Connection: The app automatically checks the standard default WSJT-X log directory for your operating system.

3. Using Custom Log Paths

If WSJT-X saves your logs in a custom directory or file name:

• Click the **Locate Log File** button in the bottom right corner.

• Select your target ADIF log file using the file browser dialog.

• The app will automatically save your choice to a **config.txt** file so it remembers the path on future startups.

4. Live Logging & Activation Tracking

• **Real-Time Sync:** Every time you complete a QSO and click 'OK' in the WSJT-X logging window, the contact automatically streams into the companion app window instantly.

• **Activation Milestone:** The contact counter badge tracks your progress toward the required 10 contacts. The moment your count hits **10**, a congratulatory pop-up message will appear confirming your activation success!

5. Exporting Your Log for POTA Upload

Once your activation is complete and you are ready to submit your logs:

• Click the **Export POTA ADIF** button at the top right.

• A save window will open with the default name **ft8_data.adif** pre-populated.

• Choose your destination folder and click Save. The file will format all contacts with the necessary POTA tags (and your park reference) ready for direct upload on the POTA website.